3.2 Methods of Cooking

"Cooking is the art of preparing food for consumption commonly with the application of heat"

Cooking techniques and ingredients vary widely across the world, reflecting unique environmental, economical, cultural and traditional trends. Art of skill and training are needed for effective cooking.

3.2.1 Objectives of Cooking

- Cooking kills micro-organisms
- Sterilizes food
- Helps to keep food longer
- Softens the food
- Aids digestion
- Improves palatability and quality of food
- Introduces variety and
- Increases the availability of nutrients.

3.2.2 Cooking Methods

Heat is transferred to the food during cooking by conduction, convection and radiation. The manner in which heat is applied to the food during cooking determines the type of cooking method used. The methods developed may be classified under three main heads:

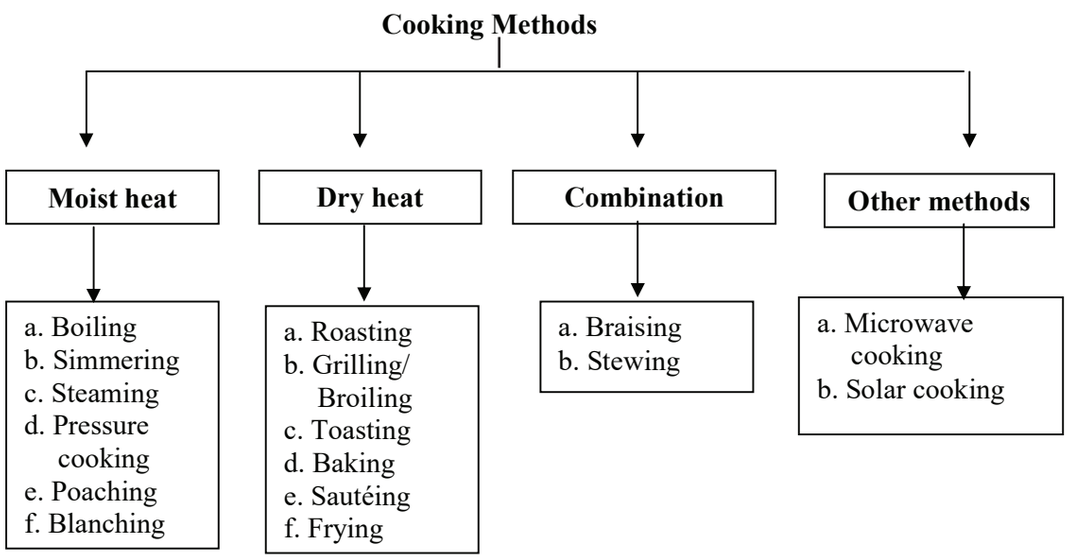
- **Moist heat:** Involves water and steam
- **Dry heat:** Involves air or fat
- **Combination Methods:** Combination of both moist heat and dry heat methods

3.2.3 Classification of Cooking Methods

I. Moist Heat Methods

a. Boiling: It is a method of cooking food by just immersing in water at 100°C and maintaining the water at that temperature till the food becomes tender. **Eg:** Rice, egg, dhal, meat, roots and tubers can be cooked by boiling.

b. Simmering: Food is cooked in liquid at a temperature just below the boiling point.



▲ Figure 3.5 Cooking Methods

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